

## Setting trends, Digit style

Needless to say, Digit has always been a trendsetter. Dishing out a free VCD with the December 2003 issue irrevocably supports that envious fact. The Digit Encyclopedia, the VCD and the four software CDs in one issue—it seemed as if I had hit the jackpot! Kudos to the entire Digit team for such a creative effort! However, I do wish to address a few issues: Firstly, Digit being a technological magazine, an old sci-fi flick such as *Blade Runner* would have been more appreciated than *Ice Age*. Secondly, keeping aside the VCD and the Encyclopedia, the other four CDs could have easily been squeezed onto a DVD with the price tag for two CDs, and the one DVD could have been set at Rs 100. I found the price too expensive. I hope to see sci-fi movie VCDs in the future from the Digit think-tank!

Arindam Sarkar, IIT, Kharagpur  
Via e-mail

Thanks for writing to us



Arindam,

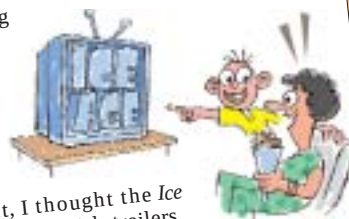
Firstly, DVD-drives are still a rarity in India, as attested by the reader feedback we got from the August 2003 Linux special. We wanted all our readers to enjoy the December package, hence the choice of CDs.

We briefly considered a science fiction movie, but decided on a broader interest movie, *Ice Age*, that everyone can enjoy, as attested by fellow reader Neha Prabhu.

## A bundle of joy

It was the sixth of December, and I was impatient for my subscription copy of Digit. Come noon, the door bell rang and voila! One cool-looking guy with my subscription issue, I was very happy. I came to my room and opened the cover. To my astonishment, I found six CDs in it! Wow, you provide your magazine with a lot of punch. For a moment, I thought the *Ice Age* VCD was a promotional CD, with trailers or advertisements, sponsored by Twentieth Century Fox. I bravely put the CD in my VCD player, and to my excitement, it was *Ice Age*, the entire movie! Fantabulous! My four-year old son and I thoroughly enjoyed the movie that day. Congratulations! Keep it up. This idea of yours is really innovative. All the Best.

Neha Prabhu  
Via e-mail



## The ratings game

In the November 2003 issue of Digit, although the Zenith PC was graded 'B-', it still won as the best performer. Why was this so?

Jishnu R  
Via e-mail

The Zenith PC won because it was the best performer. It beat just about everything else, in almost every test. However, our ratings (A, A-, B+, B, B-, etc.) also take into consideration the Value For Money (VFM) scores. We calculate this score by adding its performance and features scores, and dividing the sum by its price. This decimal value is then fed into a calculator that determines a product's VFM.

Complicated? Sure, but this is the best way to make an accurate judgment. The Zenith PC beat all the others, but cost a whole lot more too. Was this increase in cost justified by a significant increase in performance? We rate products, and have two categories—Value Winners and Performance Winners—so that you can make an informed decision to buy the products that best suit your needs, as well as your pockets.

## From the Forum ([www.thinkdigit.com/forum](http://www.thinkdigit.com/forum))

### lost\_in\_the\_discussions

#### Analogue Novice

Digitized!

Joined:  
10 Dec 2003  
Posts: 8

Posted: Wed Dec 10, 2003 2:39 pm Post subject: Ads, ads and ads!!

At first sight, there was one thing that irritated me in the December issue of Digit—the ads. Since I am doing my Business Management course, let me tell you something from the Business point of view. Digit is a business establishment which exists to make money. And when you talk about the business model of any media, be it newspapers, be it magazines or even television programs, they survive and run because of advertisements.

### super\_ferrari

Resident Techie  
Joined:  
05 Dec 2003  
Posts: 89

Yeah ads are necessary for a business organization's existence....even our super rich master blaster Sachin does so many ads...does he need dem?!... But using models on da cover page of Digit makes it look like some Bollywood mag rather dan technology mag. Overall I am satisfied with DIGIT...a really informative mag.

### lost\_in\_the\_discussions

#### Analogue Novice

Joined:  
10 Dec 2003  
Posts: 8

If you see other technology magazines, all they have on their cover page is some boring graphics, or at most, some computer component. I think these cover models give Digit a different look. And don't tell me that you don't like nice girls!!

## Goof Ups

- E.S.Chandrasekaran of BSNL has pointed out some factual errors in Insight on Virtual Private Networking: BSNL offers two types of VPN services for data communication—MPLS-VPN and IP-VPN. It also offers IP-VPN services through BSNL's Internet nodes located throughout the country.
- The price of the Sony SDM N80 18-inch LCD is 1,27,000, and not 1,29,00. Whew, arent you glad

Notice any goof-ups?  
Write to [goof@jasubhai.com](mailto:goof@jasubhai.com)

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